

Wie Gemalt

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translated by Bethan David



The mitts are inspired by a painting of mine. I cut a stencil for a knot — and later decided that I want to crochet that knot as well.

These mitts are crocheted using slip stitches. The cable is created horizontally, a technique I invented. The braid can be used as the thumb hole.

Size

The mitts are about 23 cm long and 7 cm wide. They can be stretched to fit a 23 cm wrist circumference. Width can easily be adjusted.

Materials

- 40 g Undercover Otter Squirm Sock (80% Extra Fine Merino, 20% Polyamide, hand-dyed on Zitron Hightwist), color Dark Skies
- 3.75 mm crochet hook
- darning needle for the invisble seam
- Optional: different colored threads to mark the strands

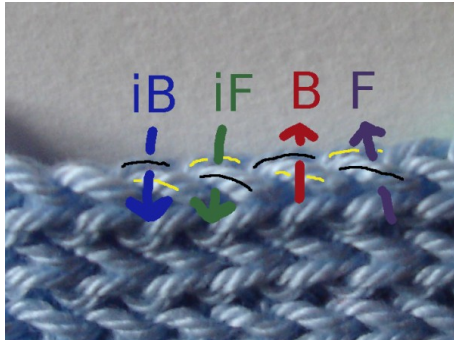
Gauge

The gauge is about 21 sts and 30 rows over 10 cm × 10 cm (4 in × 4 in), in back loop only slip stitches (see page 5).



Abbreviations

I use David Burchall's terminology in naming the slip stitches.



- st: stitch
- sts: stitches
- ch: chain(s)
- F: slip stitch into the front loop (see page 4)
- B: slip stitch into the back loop (see page 5)
- iB: inverse slip stitch into the back loop (see page 5)
- $cf_1(cf_2, cf_3 \dots)$: cable front (move the working yarn around the first (second, third. . .) strand with the yarn in front), see page 7.
- $cb_1(cb_2, cb_3 \dots)$: cable behind (move the working yarn around the first (second, third. . .) strand with the yarn in back), see page 7.
- tch: turning chain

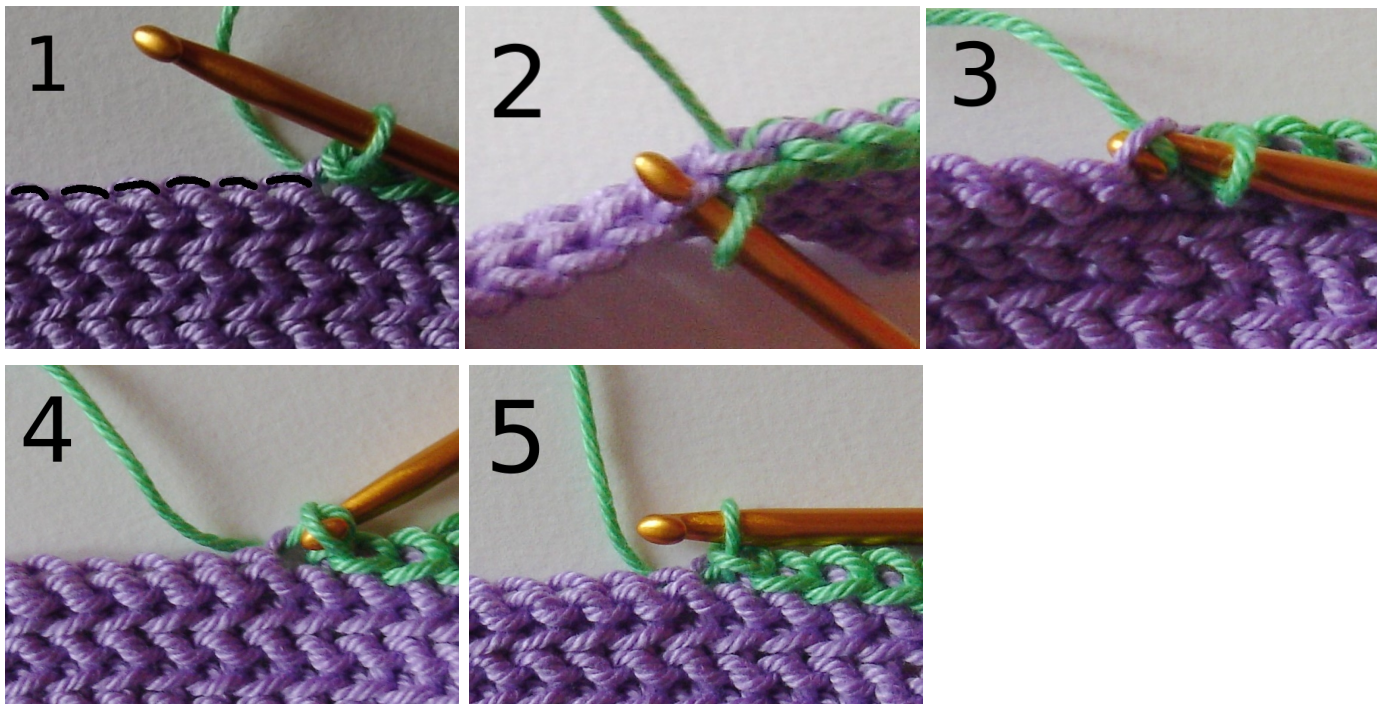
The mitts are crocheted using F, B and iB. Turning chains are not necessary in slip stitch patterns. In this pattern, they are recommended because they make the fabric stretchier.

Stitch Tutorials

In case you are new to slip stitch crochet: Before you start on the pattern, take some non-splitty yarn that is easy to rip, choose a pointy smooth hook that is about 2 mm larger than the one you'd normally use and practice the basic stitch. Try to have as little tension as possible (that works for most people). In particular, if you hold the yarn by wrapping it several times around your index finger, try to change to a way without the extra wraps, so the yarn can flow through your fingers.

F

Picture 1 shows which loops to use. The sample is made in F only stitches for all rows. With the yarn in back, insert the hook from the front into the front loop (2), yarn over, draw the hook through all loops (3 and 4).



B

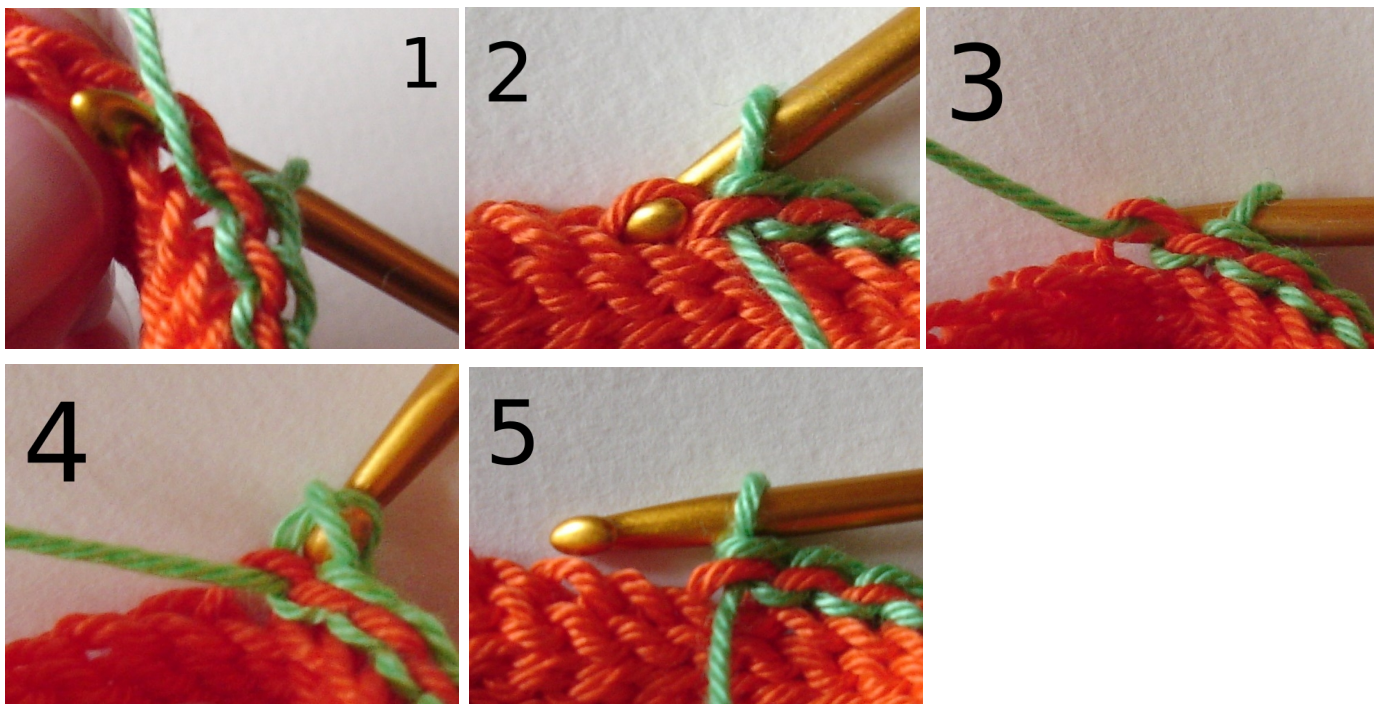
Insert the hook from the front into the back loop, yarn over, draw hook through all loops.



iB

The sample is crocheted in F for odd rows, iB for even rows. Shown is an even row in progress.

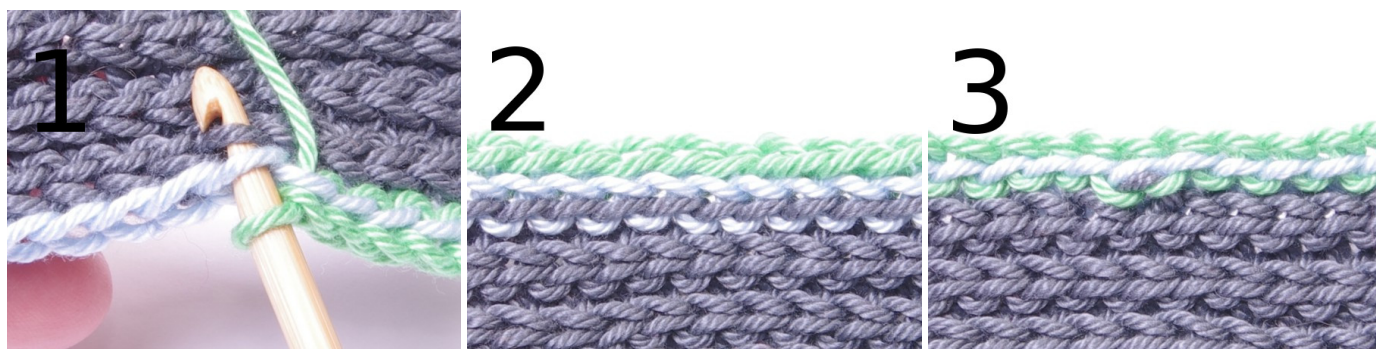
With the yarn in front of the work, insert the hook from the back into the back loop (1 and 2), yarn over, draw the hook through all loops (3 and 4).



Techniques

Anchor Stitch

If there will be a lot of tension on a particular B stitch, it can be ‘anchored’. To anchor the stitch, insert the hook through the back loop (light blue in picture 1) and through the loop directly underneath in the previous row. This will not show at all from the front and looks like regular rows of B (picture 2), but you can see it from the back (picture 3). Therefore, an anchor stitch should only be used if the wrong side will not be visible.



Horizontal Six-Stranded Braid

For the six-stranded braid, begin with the first strand which is worked like a buttonhole, as with any horizontal braid. In the pictures I have worked each strand in a different color. As you crochet each strand they can be marked with threads of different colors in order to distinguish them.

The last row in front of the braid (gray) is the *base row*.

Each row ends with a turning chain which will not be specifically mentioned in the instructions below.

Some tips for cabling:

This is not a beginner's cable pattern. If you have never worked a horizontal cable before, make a swatch to test the technique or work one of my easier cable patterns.

Make sure that you don't twist the chain.

You can secure the open loop with a stitch marker while you move the chains around the other strands.

Make sure that the working yarn always stays on top of the chains, in other words: to the right.

Before the return row, make sure to take out the hook and put the working yarn to the other side of the open loop, otherwise things will get a bit tangled.

Begin by chaining 47 plus 1 tch. Work 4 rows of B, then 1 row of iB (picture 1). Now begin the braid.



Strand 1: F 7, ch 36, skip 21, F 19 (picture 2) (= 62 sts)

Work 3 rows of B over 62 sts (picture 3).



Strand 2: B 4, ch 9 (picture 4), skip 9, B 10 (picture 5), ch 21, skip 23, B 16 (picture 6)
(= 60 sts)

Work 3 rows of B over 60 sts (picture 7).



Strand 3: Anchor 1 B (see page 6), ch 9, skip 9, B 11, ch 15 (picture 8), cf₂, cb₁(picture 9), F 5 into the base row (picture 10), ch 6 (picture 11), cb₁, cf₂, B 12 (picture 12) (= 59 sts)

Work 3 rows of B over 59 sts (picture 13).



Strand 4: Anchor 1 B, ch 9 (picture 14), cf_3 , cb_2 , cf_1 (picture 15), F 11 into the base row (picture 16), ch 23 (picture 17), cf_1 (picture 18), **cb_3** , **cb_2** (picture 19), B 15, at the same time anchoring the first stitch (picture 20) (= 59 sts)

Work 3 rows of B over 59 sts (picture 21).



Strand 5: Anchor 1 B, ch 9, skip 9, also cb₃, cf₂, cb₁(picture 22), B 10, ch 3, cf₄(picture 23), F 5 into the base row, ch 18 (picture 24), cb₃, cf₁, cb₂, cf₄(picture 25), B 12 (picture 26) (= 58 sts)

Work 3 rows of B over 58 sts (picture 27).



Strand 6: B 4, ch 9, skip 9, also cf₃, cb₂, cf₁, B 9, ch 11 (picture 28), cb₁(picture 29), cf₃(picture 30), cb₄(picture 31), B 3, at the same time anchoring the first and third sts (picture 32), ch 10, cf₂, cb₄(picture 33), B 16 (picture 34) (= 62 sts)
Work 3 rows of B over 62 sts (picture 35).



The next row is crocheted into the side of the strand. It is important not to twist the strand as you work. The stitches in the row which you work into can be seen as small hearts, the tip of the heart points away from the hook (picture 36).



Work B 7 into the 6th strand,
on the 3rd strand skip 9, B 11 (picture 37),
on the 2nd strand skip 3, B 5,
on the 4th strand skip 14, B 5,
B 19 into the 6th strand (= 47 sts).



Picture 38 shows the completed braid.



Invisible Seam

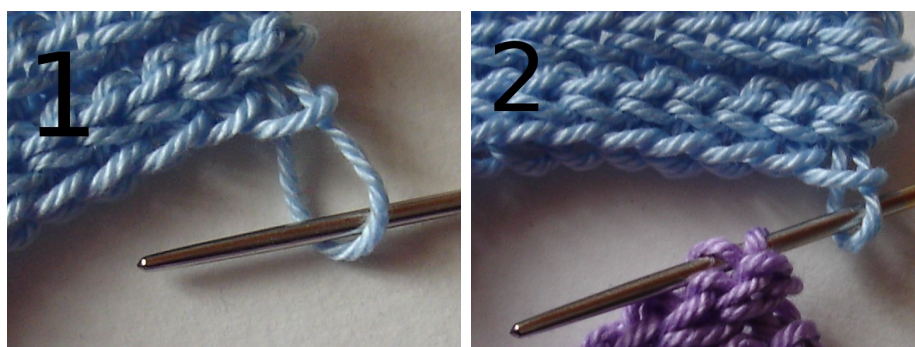
Slip stitches are nothing but chains that are connected with other stitches — in other words: relatively simply, they can be seamed invisibly when worked in a sideways tube. Still, there are a confusing lot of loops to take care of, so I recommend to practice seaming with some rippable yarn on a test swatch.

Things that might help until you have had some practice: On your test piece, put markers into the back bars of the beginning chain before you continue with the first row. Work the test piece in different colors, as in the pictures below.

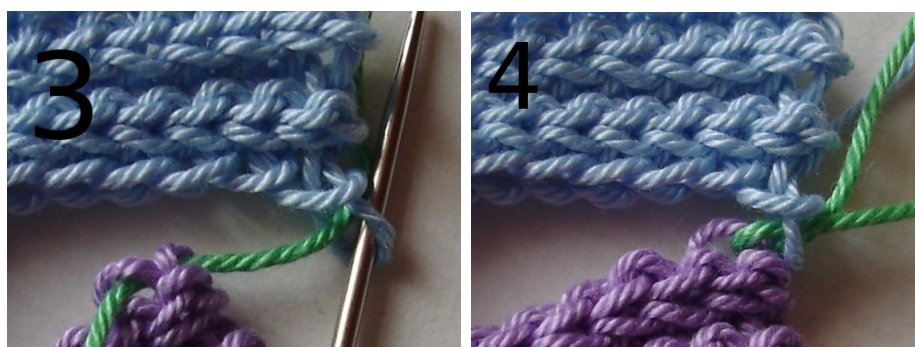
Do not fasten off before making the seam, skip the turning chain and then cut the yarn generously (five times the length of the seam plus some extra for sewing in the end) and thread it into a darning needle.

Place mitten before you. The starting tail should be on the bottom on the left and the live loop and sewing needle should be on the top on the right. Fold up the bottom edge (purple) and fold down the top edge (blue) so that they form a tube.

For starting, insert the needle through the loop of the live stitch (picture 1). Identify the first two back bars of the starting chain. Insert the needle front to back into the first bump and back to front into the second bump (picture 2).



Insert the needle back through the open loop (picture 3). The first stitch is done (picture 4).

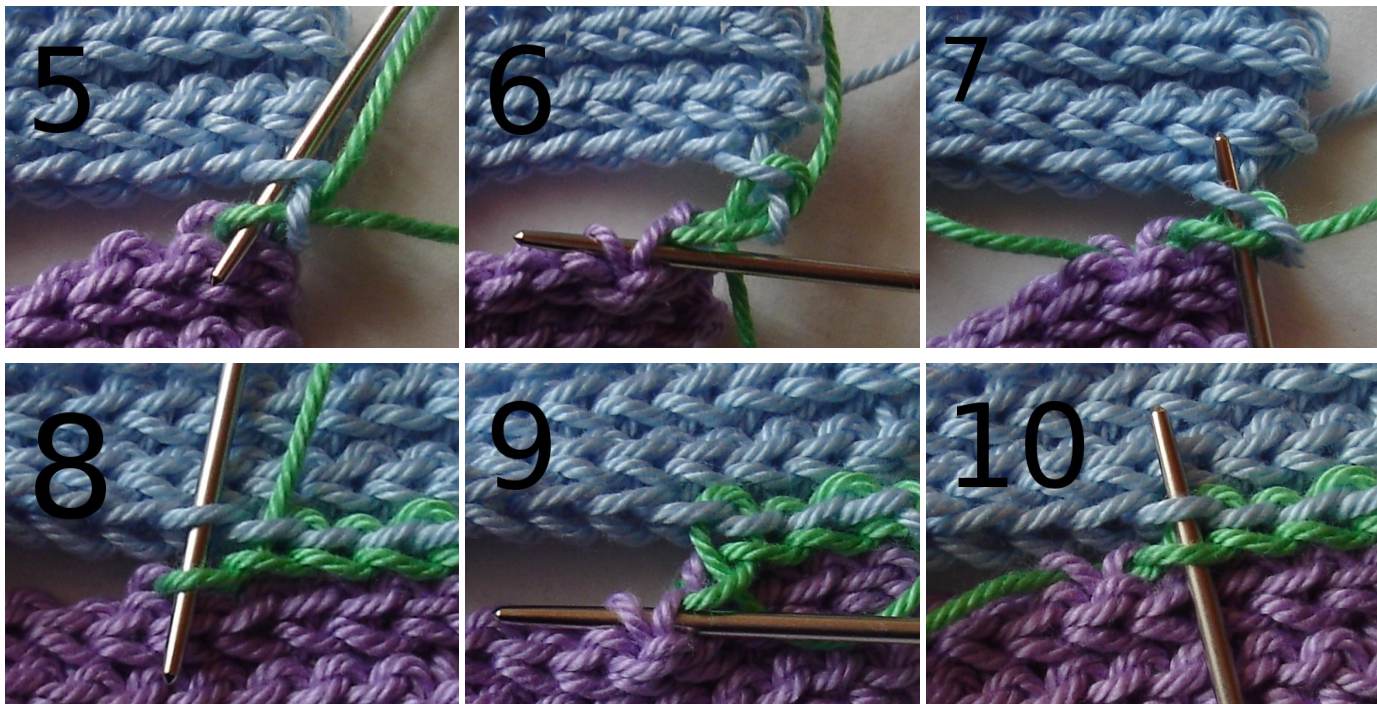


Continue with steps 1-3 until the end.

Step 1: Insert the needle from the top through the next back loop (blue) and further down through the loose loop formed by the last step (green) (pictures 5 and 8). Gently pull the loose loop tight while the needle is still in the loops. Pull needle through.

Step 2: Insert the needle from the front through the back bar used last, then from the back through the next back bar (purple) (pictures 6 and 9). Pull needle through, leaving the loop loose.

Step 3: Go up through the loose green loop and the blue loop used in step 1 (pictures 7 and 10). Gently pull the loose loop tight but make sure the horizontal loop you are forming stays loose for now.



For the last stitch of the seam, Step 2 is just worked through the one loop remaining. Step 1 and Step 3 stay the same.

Instructions

The mitts are worked sideways in rows. Every row ends with a turning chain.

The last row in front of the braid is the *base row*.

Left Mitt

On page 7 are the detailed instructions with pictures; here are the instructions without pictures if you prefer to print it this way.

Begin by chaining 47 plus 1 tch. Work 4 rows of B, then 1 row of iB. Now begin the braid.

Strand 1: F 7, ch 36, skip 21, F 19 (= 62 sts)

Work 3 rows of B over 62 sts.

Strand 2: B 4, ch 9, skip 9, B 10, ch 21, skip 23, B 16 (= 60 sts)

Work 3 rows of B over 60 sts.

Strand 3: Anchor 1 B, ch 9, skip 9, B 11, ch 15, cf₂, cb₁, F 5 into the base row, ch 6, cb₁, cf₂, B 12 (= 59 sts)

Work 3 rows of B over 59 sts.

Strand 4: Anchor 1 B (see page 6), ch 9, cf₃, cb₂, cf₁, F 11 into the base row, ch 23, cf₁, **cb₃**, **cb₂**, B 15, at the same time anchoring the first stitch

Work 3 rows of B over 59 sts.

Strand 5: Anchor 1 B, ch 9, skip 9, also cb₃, cf₂, cb₁, B 10, ch 3, cf₄, F 5 into the base row, ch 18, cb₃, cf₁, cb₂, cf₄, B 12 (= 58 sts)

Work 3 rows of B over 58 sts.

Strand 6: B 4, ch 9, skip 9, also cf₃, cb₂, cf₁, B 9, ch 11, cb₁, cf₃, cb₄, B 3, at the same time anchoring the first and third sts, ch 10, cf₂, cb₄, B 16 (= 62 sts)

Work 3 rows of B over 62 sts.

The next row is worked into the side of the strand.

Work B 7 into the 6th strand,

on the 3rd strand skip 9, B 11,

on the 2nd strand skip 3, B 5,

on the 4th strand skip 14, B 5,

B 19 into the 6th strand (= 47 sts).

Work 1 Row of iB, then 1 row of F. Continue with B in rows until 5 ribs are formed after the flat section after the braid. Work 1 more row of B.

Put the mitt around your arm to see if it fits. To adjust the width, work an even number of rows more or fewer.

The open loop is now diagonally opposite the starting tail. Fold the mitt into a tube and join with the invisible seam (see page 14).

Sew in the ends.

Right Mitt

Begin by chaining 47 plus 1 tch. Work 4 rows of B, then 1 row of iB. Now begin the braid. It is worked like the left one, with the exception of the cabling: Each cb is replaced by a cf and vice versa. This makes the cables symmetrical. But if you prefer to use the pictured instructions on page 7 then you can make both mitts exactly the same.

Strand 1: F 7, ch 36, skip 21, F 19 (= 62 sts)

Work 3 rows of B over 62 sts.

Strand 2: B 4, ch 9, skip 9, B 10, ch 21, skip 23, B 16 (= 60 sts)

Work 3 rows of B over 60 sts.

Strand 3: Anchor 1 B, ch 9, skip 9, B 11, ch 15, cb₂, cf₁, F 5 into the base row, ch 6, cf₁, cb₂, B 12 (= 59 sts)

Work 3 rows of B over 59 sts.

Strand 4: Anchor 1 B, ch 9, cb₃, cf₂, cb₁, F 11 into the base row, ch 23, cb₁, **cf₃**, **cf₂**, B 15, at the same time anchoring the first stitch

Work 3 rows of B over 59 sts.

Strand 5: Anchor 1 B, ch 9, skip 9, also cf₃, cb₂, cf₁, B 10, ch 3, cb₄, F 5 into the base row, ch 18, cf₃, cb₁, cf₂, cb₄, B 12 (= 58 sts)

Work 3 rows of B over 58 sts.

Strand 6: B 4, ch 9, skip 9, also cb₃, cf₂, cb₁, B 9, ch 11, cf₁, cb₃, cf₄, B 3, at the same time anchoring the first and third sts, ch 10, cb₂, cf₄, B 16 (= 62 sts)

Work 3 rows of B over 62 sts.

The next row is worked into the side of the strand.

B 7 into the 6th strand,

on the 3rd strand skip 9, B 11,

on the 2nd strand skip 3, B 5,

on the 4th strand skip 14, B 5,

B 19 into the 6th strand (= 47 sts).

Work 1 Row of iB, then 1 row of F. Continue with B in rows until 5 ribs are formed after the flat section after the braid.

Work 1 more row of B.

Make any adjustments for width in the same way as for the Left Mitt.

The open loop is now diagonally opposite the starting tail. Fold the mitt into a tube and join with the invisible seam (see page 14).

Sew in the ends.

